

Benny and the Golden Carrot

An Interactive Story for Little Readers

Background Music Description

Opening & Main Theme: Soft, playful ukulele with gentle xylophone chimes — warm and curious, like a sunny morning in a meadow. Tempo: slow and bouncy (♩ = 72). When Benny feels brave, add a light glockenspiel trill. During tense moments, lower the ukulele to a single plucked note with a quiet cello hum underneath. Resolution ends with a full, bright strum and birdsong fade-out.

Illustration Prompt 1 — *The Discovery*

A golden carrot glowing softly in a forest clearing, rays of warm light beaming down through tall green trees. A small brown rabbit with big round eyes and a red scarf crouches nearby, ears perked up, one paw reaching forward with wonder and hesitation. Watercolor style, pastel palette, whimsical and gentle.

The Story Begins

Benny the rabbit had the floppiest ears in the whole Clover Valley — and the biggest heart.

One bright Tuesday morning, Benny was hopping through Whispering Wood when something made him stop *completely* still.

There, sitting in a patch of sunlight, was the most beautiful carrot he had ever seen. It was **golden**, it was enormous, and it sparkled like it had been dipped in morning dew.

"Oh my," Benny whispered.

He looked left. He looked right. Nobody was around. He picked up the carrot — and it felt warm and wonderful in his paws.

But then he heard a small, sad sound.

Sniff. Sniff.

Behind a mossy log sat his best friend, **Rosie the squirrel**, her cheeks wet with tears.

"My golden carrot," she cried. "I grew it all spring for Grandma's birthday. Now I've lost it and Grandma is waiting and — oh, it's hopeless!"

Benny looked down at the carrot in his paws. His tummy did a funny little flip.

🌟 DECISION POINT 1 — *What should Benny do?*

Choice A: Benny quietly tucks the carrot behind his back and says, *"I haven't seen any carrot, Rosie. Sorry!"*

Choice B: Benny takes a deep breath, steps forward, and holds out the golden carrot. *"I think... this might be yours."*

→ **If you chose Choice A:** Benny walks home, but the carrot doesn't feel warm anymore. It feels heavy. He can't eat his lunch. He can't sleep. The next morning, he runs back to find Rosie — but she's already gone to Grandma's with nothing to give. Benny sits alone, and a little voice in his heart says: *"You can still fix this."* (Story continues to Decision Point 2.)

→ **If you chose Choice B:** Rosie gasps, then breaks into the biggest smile. *"BENNY! You found it!"* She squeezes him so tight his ears go sideways. Benny feels like sunshine from his nose to his toes. But now he has a new problem — he still needs to get Rosie to Grandma's house safely and **fast**. (Story continues to Decision Point 2.)



Illustration Prompt 2 — *The Crossroads*

A winding forest path splitting into two trails — one dark and tangled with shadows, one bright with daisies and butterflies. Benny stands at the fork, red scarf blowing in the breeze, looking determined. Rosie the squirrel stands beside him holding the golden carrot, both looking ahead together. Soft watercolor, warm afternoon light.

🌟 DECISION POINT 2 — *How does Benny make things right?*

Choice A: Benny runs to Grandma Hazel's house and *tells the truth* about finding the carrot, even the part where he almost kept it.

Choice B: Benny stays quiet about almost keeping it and just smiles and says nothing.

→ **If you chose Choice A:** Grandma Hazel listens with kind, crinkly eyes. Then she takes Benny's paw and says, *"Do you know what makes a rabbit truly brave? Not having no fear — but telling the truth even when your tummy flips."* She gives him a warm carrot muffin. It is the best thing he has ever tasted.

→ **If you chose Choice B:** The party is lovely, but every time someone says *"How wonderful Benny is!"* he feels a little smaller. On the walk home, he finally tells Rosie the whole truth. She squeezes his paw. *"I'm glad you told me,"* she says. *"That's the bravest thing of all."*



The Ending

That night, Benny looked up at the stars from his little burrow.

His heart wasn't flipping anymore.

It was full.

Honesty, he thought, feels exactly like sunshine — even when it's a little bit scary first.

THE END. ✨



Illustration Prompt 3 — *The Warm Ending*

Benny tucked into a cozy round burrow at night, wrapped in a patchwork blanket, smiling softly with eyes half-closed. Through his little circular window, a sky full of stars glitters outside. On his bedside table sits a small golden carrot and a half-eaten muffin. Warm amber candlelight glow, soft watercolor, dreamy and peaceful.



Narration Script Notes

- **Narrator voice:** Warm, unhurried, slightly playful. Think a beloved grandparent telling a story by lamplight.
 - **Benny's voice:** Small, earnest, a little breathless with excitement.
 - **Rosie's voice:** Higher-pitched, expressive, quick — cheerful when happy, very genuine when sad.
 - **Grandma Hazel's voice:** Deep, slow, comforting — every word like a hug.
 - **Pause cues:** Hold 2 seconds at each ✨ DECISION POINT before reading options, so young listeners can think and choose.
 - **Emphasis words** (read warmly, not loudly): *brave, truth, golden, sunshine, together.*
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Word count: ~610 words | Recommended age: 5–7 | Theme: Honesty & Courage